Neal T. Gillespie

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Hiring Committee
Yorba Linda Public Library
4852 Lakeview Avenue
Yorba Linda, CA 92886

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Library Clerk position with the Yorba Linda Public Library. I have spent four years in nonprofit development, and the work I kept gravitating toward was organizing collections so other people could find things in them. I am now moving into library work deliberately.

The core of this role is operating an integrated library system accurately: checking materials in and out, registering patrons, keeping borrower records confidential, and searching bibliographic information. I have built that kind of system rather than only used one. In my current role I oversee a physical archive of printed materials and built the searchable catalog and database behind it. Outside work I founded the Free Knowledge Library, where I designed the classification scheme and built the catalog, and StateTrack, a public database of campaign finance records covering all fifty states. I understand what a record needs to contain to stay findable, which is most of what careful circulation work protects.

On the public-facing side, I staffed the registrar service window at Chapman University’s Fowler School of Law. That meant assisting people in person and on the phone, explaining procedures, handling confidential records, and processing over five hundred transcripts and exam documents accurately. Fast-paced desk work under procedure is familiar to me, as is the discretion that borrower records require.

I should say plainly that I am able to relocate. I have family in Southern California who can host me during an interim move, which makes getting out there straightforward. I can work a regularly scheduled weekend day and evenings.

I have begun the ALA’s Library Support Staff Certification and start a Library and Information Services certificate in the spring, with a master’s to follow. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie